

FEBRUARY 1-15, 1979

prepared a comprehensive coastal security plan four years ago to protect its 1,600-km-long coastline. But every time it sent reminders to the Centre seeking its approval, there was no response from the Home Ministry. Playing politics with national security has been responsible for the Mumbai holocaust, and the Union Government is to be squarely blamed. A terror attack of such magnitude is nothing but a wake-up call for the Centre and the states to set aside their differences and come together to combat such crises.

A. SRIKANTAIAH,
 via www.indiatoday.in

Big Boss

General Ashfaq Parvez Kayani is the man who is running the show in Pakistan ("The Real Boss", December 22). A country that has always been under the army's control doesn't know what democracy means. It's a facade that provides safe cover to the military to raise its ugly head against India. Together with the ISI, Pakistan's army has been supporting fundamentalists as they spread and sponsor terrorism in India. Pakistan has ruled out any support to India and will never come ahead to dismantle terrorist infrastructure from its soil. Pakistan's blatant denial is nothing, but a silent acceptance of its grue-

some role in the carnage of Mumbai.

K.R. SRINIVASAN,
 via www.indiatoday.in

People Power

The issue ("Declare War on Terror", December 15) was hot. And I felt hotter after reading your brilliant editorial ("Pledge to Win This War"). Other stories and reports were also oozing with anger. You are right. The time for staying angry has come and so has the time for citizens to declare war on terror.

S.M. SIVARAMAN, Chennai

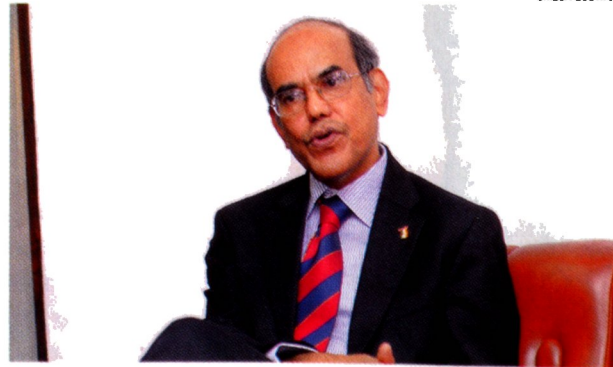
act. This initiative of launching a war on terror is a welcome step to involve common people who are the worst sufferers.

PHILIP VERGHESE ARIEL,
 via www.indiatoday.in

NSG Hubs

The news item regarding NSG hubs ("All for Change", January 5) claimed that then Finance Minister P. Chidambaram vetoed the then home minister's proposal for establishing new NSG hubs citing financial constraints. No such proposal was sent to the Ministry of Finance until November 30, 2008, the

JAMES GOSWAMI



The Centre has done enough to rescue the battered economy which may fetch rich rewards in the next elections. But will it be able to end the common man's woes, who has to earn, spend and save as well?

ARUN CHATURVEDI, via www.indiatoday.in

Apropos of the edit, we, the people, are no doubt fed up with politicians' false promises, the ineptitude of our security and intelligence agencies and the slow judicial process. This is the right time to

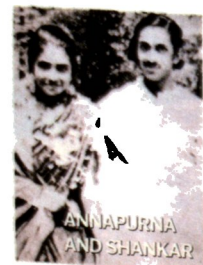
day the finance minister demitted office. Hence, there was no question of him turning it down.

ONKAR KEDIA, ADG (M&C),
 Ministry of Home Affairs, Delhi.
 The error is regretted.
 EDITOR

Amorous Tale

For almost three decades now, Pandit Ravi Shankar, 59, India's famed sitarist has consistently made good copy, and hordes of music scribes have capitalised financially on writing about the maestro. The shoe is now on the other foot, with Shankar himself taking a literary romp down memory lane in *Raag-Anuraag*, his musical-erotic autobiography, currently being serialised in a Calcutta literary journal, *Desh*. His book is the first Bengali autobiography where the author recounts his amorous adventures. It also purports to take a look at his marital relationship—hitherto considered sacrosanct in the puritanical world to Indian music. He does not conceal the fact that his marriage to Annapurna was one of convenience. Shankar was learning the sitar from Ustad Alauddin Khan, who had to be kept in "good humour"—marrying his daughter being part of the methods employed.

Dilip Bobb and Sumit Mitra



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